solution. . . . Egypt cannot do anything. . . . My fear is that the world will stop taking an interest in the problem. . . . In light of this, there is no choice but to make a move and make the world interested in the problem again—for the sake of a peaceful solution—by limited military action."

3. In February 1972, during a visit to Moscow, Sadat told his hosts: "We need to carry out a limited military operation in the second half of 1972, for example at the passes [i.e., the Mitla and Gidi passes, which lead from the Sinai Peninsula to the eastern bank of the Suez Canal]. After achieving this goal we can emphasize our desire to find a peaceful solution and to open the Canal."
4. In January 1973, Sadat wrote the following to Soviet leader Leonid Brezhnev: "Our belief is becoming stronger that as long as Israel is not convinced that we can resist its forces, defeat them and change the military situation, it will not agree to withdraw from our occupied lands."
5. In April 1973, a reliable source reported there was no diplomatic solution on the horizon. Sadat had serious intentions to resume fighting in the near future in order to break the deadlock, even in the knowledge that the chances of success were small and that he might lose his position in the event of failure. This was a move of desperation.

The Determination to Go to War

In February 1973, Sadat said, "A basic principle of history is that as long as our armed forces do not enter into battle, our people will lose their manhood for the next millennium. It is a thousand times more honorable to die fighting than to continue to stand as we are until it ends in our surrender."

Military Action as Part of a Plan to Gain International Support

In August 1972, Sadat was presented with a memorandum on Egyptian policy planning for 1972–73. The author of the memorandum was Hafez Ismail, the president's national security adviser. Ismail recommended: